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DATE: February 17, 2026

TO: V&V Framework Stakeholders

SUBJECT: NASA CUI Directive Requirements Absorption

OFFICE OF PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITY: Compliance-Marking

1. **Purpose**

This memorandum documents the decision to absorb NASA's CUI directive hierarchy into formal requirements artifacts. Two documents are captured: the current active NPR 2810.7 "Controlled Unclassified Information" and the expired interim NID 2810.135. Together they demonstrate the systems-engineering framework's ability to absorb external governing-authority requirements and produce formal Verification & Validation (V&V) artifacts.

2. **Background**

NASA's Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) program standardizes how sensitive information is marked, handled, and shared across the agency. The program is governed by a directive hierarchy:

- **Federal Level:** Executive Order 13556 (establishing the CUI program) and 32 CFR Part 2002 (implementation regulation)
- **NASA Policy:** NPD 2810.1F "NASA Information Security Policy" (effective Jan 21, 2022; expires Jan 21, 2027) — establishes overarching information security policy and mandates the CUI program per EO 13556
- **NASA Procedure (Current):** NPR 2810.7 "Controlled Unclassified Information" Change 1 (effective Oct 22, 2021; expires Oct 22, 2026) — 23 subsections covering all CUI management procedures. This is the **current active governing document** for production use.
- **NASA Interim (Expired):** NID 2810.135 "Controlled Unclassified Information" (effective Feb 2, 2021; expired Feb 2, 2022) — interim directive whose requirements were carried forward into NPR 2810.7

NID 2810.135 is publicly available at: https://nodis3.gsfc.nasa.gov/OPD_docs/NID_2810_135_.pdf



NPR 2810.7 is available at: <https://nodis3.gsfc.nasa.gov/displayDir.cfm?t=NPR&c=2810&s=7>

3. Analysis

Why use expired NID 2810.135 rather than active NPR 2810.7?

- **Safe test data:** The expired status means no compliance obligations arise from citing it. It cannot be mistaken for an active requirement source.
- **Framework demonstration:** The goal is to prove the REQ/VER toolchain can absorb a complex, multi-chapter directive with diverse requirement types (technical, organizational, informational). NID 2810.135 serves this purpose.
- **Full lifecycle visibility:** Using an expired directive shows the complete lifecycle: active → superseded → archived. The successor relationship (NID 2810.135 → NPR 2810.7) is documented in the artifact metadata.
- **Requirements equivalence:** All normative requirements in NID 2810.135 were carried forward into NPR 2810.7. The test data is representative of real CUI requirements without creating ambiguity about which standard is authoritative.
- **Publicly shareable:** NID 2810.135 is a public document. Artifacts derived from it can be freely shared, discussed, and used as examples.

4. Decision

Approved: Absorb both NASA CUI directives as formal requirements artifacts.

Artifacts to be produced:

- **REQ-2026-002:** JSON requirements extraction from NID 2810.135 (expired interim directive) — serves as framework test data demonstrating full lifecycle
- **REQ-2026-003:** JSON requirements extraction from NPR 2810.7 (current active procedural requirement) — the authoritative CUI standard for production compliance
- **VER-2026-002:** LaTeX verification document verifying ORBIT-RIFD-Status against applicable technical requirements from both REQ documents
- **build-requirements-pdf.py:** Parameterized build script generating PDF from JSON (adapted from SendCUIEmail REQ-2026-001 toolchain)

Scope: REQ extraction from both directives, plus VER against ORBIT-RIFD-Status as a real-world verification target. ORBIT-RIFD-Status is ideal because it handles CUI data daily (ISS program CEFs/PIAs), implements CUI markings on outputs, uses DPAPI database encryption, and requires CAC/PIV authentication.

Rationale for both documents:

- **NPR 2810.7** is the current governing authority — production projects reference REQ-2026-003



- **NID 2810.135** (expired) demonstrates the expired-directive lifecycle and serves as safe, shareable test data
- Requirements are substantively equivalent; the interim directive's requirements were carried forward into NPR 2810.7

5. Implementation Notes

- Both REQ JSONs include a `source_document` metadata block recording: document ID, status, successor/predecessor references, and provenance URLs
- REQ-2026-002 (NID) includes an expired-status warning and test-data disclaimer
- REQ-2026-003 (NPR) is marked as the current active governing document
- Each requirement carries an `applicability` field: `technical` (verifiable against software), `organizational` (requires process/policy), or `informational` (reference material)
- The build script is backward-compatible with REQ-2026-001 (graceful fallback when new fields are absent)
- VER-2026-002 lives in the ORBIT-CEF-Status repository (co-located with the implementation it verifies)

6. References

- NID 2810.135: https://nodis3.gsfc.nasa.gov/OPD_docs/NID_2810_135_.pdf
- NPR 2810.7: <https://nodis3.gsfc.nasa.gov/displayDir.cfm?t=NPR&c=2810&s=7>
- NPD 2810.1F: <https://nodis3.gsfc.nasa.gov/displayDir.cfm?t=NPD&c=2810&s=1E>
- NASA CUI Program: <https://www.nasa.gov/controlled-unclassified-information-cui-and>
- EO 13556: <https://www.archives.gov/cui/registry/policy-guidance>
- 32 CFR Part 2002: <https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-32/subtitle-B/chapter-XX/part-2002>
- NARA CUI Registry: <https://www.archives.gov/cui>
- REQ-2026-001 (SendCUIEmail precedent): Cryptographic Compliance Requirements
- VER-2026-001 (SendCUIEmail precedent): Cryptographic Compliance Verification
- Related Decision: DM-2026-001 (SF901 LaTeX Recreation)